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DELIVERED VIA EMAIL ONLY

May 5, 2023

Orinthia Montague, PhD
President
Volunteer State Community College

Cassie Koester, DNP, RN
Dean of Nursing
Volunteer State Community College
1480 Nashville Pike
Gallatin, TN 37066

Dear Dr. Montague and Dr. Koester:

This letter is formal notification of the action taken by the Accreditation Commission for Education in Nursing (ACEN) at its meeting in April 2023. The Board of Commissioners granted initial accreditation to the associate program and scheduled the next evaluation visit for Fall 2027. Based on ACEN Policy #34 Candidacy for a Governing Organization/Nursing Program Seeking Initial Accreditation, the effective date for initial accreditation of the nursing program is February 16, 2021. Please see ACEN Policy #9 Disclosure of Information About an Accredited Program for the required disclosure statement regarding this decision, which must be made to all current and prospective students within seven business days of this letter.

Deliberations centered on the materials available to the Board from this accreditation review process and the recommendation for accreditation proposed by the peer evaluators on the site visit team (if applicable) and the Evaluation Review Panel. Final decisions were made based on the 2023 Standards and Criteria.

The Board identified the following:

Areas Needing Development

Standard 1 Mission and Administrative Capacity, Criterion 1.3

- Ensure that data from the assessment of end-of-program student learning outcomes are shared with the communities of interest.

Standard 2 Faculty and Staff, Criterion 2.4

- Ensure that preceptors are academically and experientially qualified, oriented, mentored, and monitored and have clearly documented roles and responsibilities.

Standard 3 Students, Criterion 3.2

- Review and revise program documents (paper and electronic) to ensure that information intended to inform the public is accurate and consistent.

Areas Needing Development (Continued)**Standard 6 Outcomes, Criterion 6.1**

- Ensure there are appropriate assessment methods that result in meaningful data for each end-of-program student learning outcome.
- Ensure assessment data are analyzed and used in program decision-making for the maintenance and improvement of students' attainment of the end-of-program student learning outcomes.
- Continue to identify and implement strategies/actions to improve achievement of the end-of-program student learning outcomes when the expected levels of achievement are not met.

Congratulations on this outstanding achievement! We look forward to continued successes for your nursing program. On behalf of the Board of Commissioners, we thank you and your colleagues for your commitment to quality nursing education. If you have questions about this action or about ACEN policies and procedures, please contact me.

Sincerely,



Nell Ard, PhD, RN, CNE, ANEF
Interim CEO, Director